Nitzan Lubianiker

Curriculum Vitae

November 2026

Contact Information:

nitsan.lubianiker@yale.edu | nl9867@princeton.edu

Academic Appointments

2023 - current		
Postdoctoral Associate	Yale Psychology Department Princeton Neuroscience Institute	Yale University Princeton University

Education

2017 - 2023		
Ph.D.	School of Psychological Sciences	Tel Aviv University
2014 - 2016		
M.Sc.	Sagol School of Neuroscience	Tel Aviv University
2011 – 2015		
Undergrad	Adi Lautman Inter-Disciplinary Program For Outstanding Students Majors: Psychology, Biology	Tel Aviv University

Publications

Pre-prints:

Lubianiker, N., Woods, B., Nitzche, F., Batzdorf, A. S., Lin. Q., Norman K.A., Turk-Browne N.B. & Sheline. Y. I. (2026) Escaping the Negative Attentional Bias in Depression with Real-Time Neurofeedback. *MedRxiv* https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.30.26363896

Peer-reviewed:

Lubianiker, N., Koren, T., Djerasi, M., Sirotkin, M., Singer, N., Jalon, I., ... & Hendler, T. (2026). Upregulation of reward mesolimbic activity and immune response to vaccination: a randomized controlled trial. *Nature Medicine*, *32*(2), 572-581. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41591-025-04140-5
* Covered by *Scientific American*, *The Guardian*, *The Economist*, *Science News*, *Science*, Smithsonian, and others (see Media Coverage)

Gurevitch, G., **Lubianiker, N**., Markovits, T., Or-Borichev, A., Fine, N. B., Fruchtman-Steinbok, T., ... & Hendler, T. (2024). Amygdala Self-Neuromodulation Capacity as a Window for Process-Related Network Recruitment. *Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B* (https://doi.org/10.1098/rstb.2024.0186)

Rotstein, M. S., Zimmerman-Brenner, S., Davidovitch, S., Ben-Haim, Y., Koryto, Y., ... **Lubianiker, N.**, ... & Raz, G. (2024). Gamified Closed-Loop Intervention Enhances Tic Suppression in Children: A Randomized Trial. *Movement Disorders*. https://doi.org/10.1002/mds.29875

Lubianiker, N., Paret, C., Dayan, P., & Hendler, T. (2022). Neurofeedback through the lens of reinforcement learning. *Trends in Neurosciences*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tins.2022.03.008

Stirner, M., Gurevitch, G., **Lubianiker, N.**, Hendler, T., Schmahl, C., & Paret, C. (2022). An investigation of awareness and metacognition in neurofeedback with the amygdala electrical fingerprint. *Consciousness and Cognition*, *98*, 103264. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.concog.2021.103264

Mazor, M., Brown, S., Ciaunica, A., Demertzi, A., Fahrenfort, J., Faivre, N., Francken, J. C., Lamy, D., Lenggenhager, B., Moutoussis, M., Nizzi, M.-C., Salomon, R., Soto, D., Stein, T., & **Lubianiker, N.** (2022). The Scientific Study of Consciousness Cannot and Should Not Be Morally Neutral. *Perspectives on Psychological Science*, 0(0). https://doi.org/10.1177/17456916221110222

Sar-El, R., Sharon, H., **Lubianiker, N.**, Hendler, T., & Raz, G. (2020). Inducing a Functional-Pharmacological Coupling in the Human Brain to Achieve Improved Drug Effect. *Frontiers in Neuroscience*, *14*, 557874. https://doi.org/10.3389/fnins.2020.557874

Lubianiker, N., Goldway, N., Fruchtman-Steinbok, T., Paret, C., Keynan, J. N., Singer, N., ... & Hendler, T. (2019). Process-based framework for precise neuromodulation. *Nature human behaviour*, *3*(5), 436-445. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-019-0573-y

Jacob, Y., Or-Borichev, A., Jackont, G., **Lubianiker, N.**, & Hendler, T. (2017, November). Network based fMRI neuro-feedback for emotion regulation; proof-of-concept. In *International Conference on Complex Networks and their Applications* (pp. 1250-1260). Springer, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-72150-7_101

Selected Media Coverage of Research

Scientific American — "Positive thinking may boost immune response from vaccines, new brain training study shows." A. Parshall, Jan. 19, 2026. https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/new-brain-training-study-could-help-explain-the-placebo-effect

The Guardian — "Positive thinking could boost immune response to vaccines, say scientists." I. Sample, Jan. 19, 2026. https://www.theguardian.com/society/2026/jan/19/positive-thinking-could-boost-immune-response-to-vaccines-study-finds

The Economist (print edition) — "Mind over matter." S. Wikeley, Jan. 24, 2026.

Science — In the Pipeline (blog), "Bearing Down on the Placebo Effect." D. Lowe, Jan. 21, 2026. *https://www.science.org/content/blog-post/bearing-down-placebo-effect*

Science News — "A study hints positive thinking could strengthen vaccine immunity." S. Makin, Jan. 30, 2026. https://www.sciencenews.org/article/placebo-brain-activity-vaccine-antibody

New Atlas — "The unusual way to boost vaccine effectiveness." Jan. 2026. https://newatlas.com/medical/vaccine-positive-thinking

Grants, Awards and Honors

2026
National Institution of Health (NIH) R21 Exploratory/Development grant ($494,000). Role: Co-Investigator

2025
The Princeton School of Engineering and Applied Sciences (SEAS) Innovation grant ($100,000).

2024

Real-Time Functional Imaging and Neurofeedback, Best Poster Award; Manheim, Germany.

2022
Teva's National Bio-innovators Forum Scholarship for Excellence in Translational Research.

Paper Publication Excellence Scholarship, Gershon H. Gordon Faculty of Social Sciences, Tel Aviv University.

2020
Dean's Excellence Scholarship for PhD Students. Gershon H. Gordon Faculty of Social Sciences, Tel Aviv University.

2019, 2022
Adams Super Center for Brain Studies - Travel Award. Tel Aviv University.

2011 - 2015
The "Adi Lautman" Full Tuition Scholarship for Outstanding Students.

Academic Teaching

2019 - 2021		
Undergrad Experimental Psychology	School of Psychological Sciences	Tel Aviv University
2020 - 2022		
Empirical workshop Mentor	Sagol Brain Institute	Sourasky Medical Center

Mentorship

Yale University
Shivani Pandey (research assistant), 2026-
Brooke Dunfsky (undergraduate) 2024-2025
Ben Scheve (undergraduate) 2024
Yannan Zhu (lab Manager and postgraduate researcher) 2023-2025
Ash Chinta (lab Manager and postgraduate researcher) 2025 -

Princeton University
Olivia Yin (undergraduate; co-mentored senior thesis), 2025-
Jean Fayad (undergraduate), 2025-2026

University of Pennsylvania
Ramya Ashish (research assistant) 2025-
Brendan Woods (research assistant) 2024-2025
Frederick Nitchie (research assistant) 2023-2024
Alexandra Batzdorf (research assistant) 2023-2025

Tel Aviv University
Shiri Mermelshtein (research assistant) 2017-2019
Liad Nachlai (undergraduate) 2020-2021
Yuli Dekel (undergraduate) 2020-2021
Ofir Asidis (undergraduate) 2020-2021
Michal Pines (undergraduate) 2021-2022
Safa Qaddah (undergraduate) 2021-2022
Netta Pinhas (undergraduate) 2021-2022

Sagol Brain Institute, Sourasky Medical Center
Liza Smilansky (research assistant) 2022-2023
Arthur Lurie (research assistant) 2020-2022
Efrat Davidov (research assistant) 2019-2021

Selected conference contributions: oral talks and poster presentations

Real-Time Functional Imaging and Neurofeedback 2026, Geneva, Switzerland, October 2026
Chairing a Symposium on decoding-based neurofeedback.
Oral talk and poster: Reduction of Negative Attentional Bias in Depression with Real-Time Neurofeedback.
Oral talk and poster: A vagal pathway from fMRI Neurofeedback-induced reward activity to peripheral immunity.

SFN, 2025, San Diego, USA, November 2025
Poster presentation: Reduction of Negative Attentional Bias in Depression with Real-Time Neurofeedback.

Real-Time Functional Imaging and Neurofeedback 2024, Manheim, Germany, November 2024
Conducting a Symposium on Mental Strategies Analysis in Neurofeedback.
Oral Talk: Reinforcement Learning Framework for Neurofeedback .

Real-Time Functional Imaging and Neurofeedback 2022, Yale University, New Haven, USA, October 2022
Conducting a Computational Workshop on Analysis Methods of Neurofeedback Training Data.
Oral Talk in a Scientific Symposium on a Reinforcement Learning framework for neurofeedback.

ISFN, January 2020
Oral Talk - Current Anatomical and Functional Approaches in fMRI.

Real-Time Functional Imaging and Neurofeedback 2019, Maastricht, Netherlands, November 2019
Oral talk - A Process-Based Framework for Neuromodulation.
Poster presentation: Methylphenidate and fMRI-Neurofeedback Combined Treatment for ADHD.

World Congress of Biological Psychiatry, Vancouver, Canada, June 2019
Oral Talk - A Process-Based Framework for Neuromodulation.

Biological Psychiatry, Kfar Blum, Israel, 2017
Oral Talk - Methylphenidate and fMRI-Neurofeedback Combined Treatment for ADHD.

Frontiers in Human Neurosciences Conference, 2016
Poster presentation - Towards fMRI-Informed EEG Neurofeedback for ADHD. *Front. Hum. Neurosci. Conference Abstract: SAN2016 Meeting.* doi: 10.3389/conf.fnhum.2016.220.00018